Q+A

A Life IN MUSIC

To celebrate five decades of a storied musical career, Padma Shri **Hariharan** *is headlining a special concert in Delhi on November 30*

Q. What can fans expect from 'Soul India', your concert in Delhi?
The show will have all my genres—popular Bollywood songs, ghazals and some Colonial Cousins' fusion, all rolled into one.

Q. What have been some of the highlights of your musical career?
One was when I got a break in television with *Shaam E Ghazal* and *Aarohi*. Later, Jaidev ji gave me a chance in the film *Gaman*, which was the turning point of my life. In the '90s, I saw the pinnacle of success. *Hazir 1* with Ustad Zakir Hussain was a big hit. Then I started singing in south Indian films, like *Roja* and *Bombay*. In 1996, Colonial Cousins happened.

Q. What you are working on currently?
A ghazal album with Farhat Shahzad, consisting of all his poetry, will release this year. I did two live shows in the memory of Mehdi Hasan sahib, which will be released as an album. I'm also working on a fusion project of classical, ghazal, thumri, trance and EDM with my son, Akshay Hariharan.

Q. Which musicians and singers do you admire the most?
I have a large body of work with Rahman, and love the way he composed and produced the tracks. I worked the same way with Leslee [Lewis], and really admire how he does his compositions, productions and musicality. Then, there have been many seniors I have admired over the years, like Asha-ji, Lata-ji, Kishore-da, Rafi-ji and Ilaiyaraaja.

–with Neha Kirpal



Photograph by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR